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RETURN

53% of Ukrainian Diaspora in EU Intend to Return Home

A survey of Ukrainian migrants in the EU reveals that 53% still intend to return home, 31% do not plan to return, and 66% remain undecided. This tripartite split indicates a large persuadable middle segment whose return decision will hinge on perceived safety, economic opportunity, and quality of life signals from Ukraine.

3R: Directly quantifies the return pipeline: over half the diaspora is a recoverable asset if Ukraine delivers credible economic and security conditions. The 66% undecided cohort is the highest-leverage target for reactivation campaigns tied to reconstruction job creation.

LINKEDIN / GRADUSAPP

Ukraine Records Europe's Largest Positive Net Migration in 2024

In 2024, Ukraine recorded Europe's largest positive net migration with over one million people returning, demonstrating that return flows are not merely aspirational but already operational at scale. Concurrently, the EU is reconsidering refugee protection for military-age men, adding a policy-driven push factor to voluntary return dynamics.

3R: Confirms that the Return pipeline is active and measurable. Policy shifts on refugee status create urgency to build absorptive capacity — jobs, housing, childcare — so returning workers integrate productively rather than face unemployment or re-emigration.

INSTAGRAM

Dodomu Digital Platform Piloted to Facilitate Ukrainian Refugee Return

Ukraine has launched a pilot version of 'Dodomu,' a digital platform designed to support Ukrainian refugees in returning home. Simultaneously, a poll indicates that half of Ukrainian refugees in Romania want to return, reinforcing demand-side readiness for structured return facilitation tools.

3R: A digital return facilitation platform is a critical infrastructure investment for the Return pillar. Matching diaspora intent data (53% want to return) with a functional support platform could significantly accelerate and smooth the reintegration process.

FACEBOOK / RUBRYKA

RECRUIT

Ukraine Recovery Conference 2026: €10B+ in Agreements Opens Mass Recruitment Demand

Prime Minister Yulia Svyrydenko announced approximately 160 agreements worth over €10 billion signed at the Ukraine Recovery Conference in Gdansk. This capital mobilization implies an imminent surge in demand for skilled professionals across construction, engineering, infrastructure, finance, and project management sectors.

3R: €10B in committed funding translates directly into tens of thousands of skilled job openings. Ukraine must develop a skills-gap mapping framework now to identify which roles cannot be filled domestically and require targeted international recruitment or accelerated upskilling of returning diaspora.



ICMPD: Ukrainian Labour Market Integration Ahead of Curve, Mobility Schemes Key

ICMPD reports that the labour market integration of Ukrainian beneficiaries of temporary protection is ahead of the curve compared to previous refugee cohorts, with mobility schemes and pathways for stay and return emerging as strategic tools. High employment rates among Ukrainians in EU countries demonstrate a skilled, work-ready diaspora.

3R: The diaspora's demonstrated employability in EU markets confirms high human capital quality. Circular mobility schemes — allowing Ukrainians to work in EU while committing to Ukraine-linked projects — represent an innovative Recruit mechanism that bridges diaspora skills to reconstruction needs without forcing permanent return.

Ukrainian Universities Launch Russian Studies Program to Fill Critical Intelligence and Diplomatic Skills Gap

Ukrainian universities are reviving Russian language and area studies programs under a 'know thy enemy' framework, reversing the post-2022 decline. The initiative reflects an emerging state demand for specialists in Russian affairs for intelligence, diplomacy, information operations, and historical documentation purposes.

3R: Illustrates proactive niche skills gap identification and curriculum adaptation. Ukraine is recruiting talent into strategically critical fields that were previously politically suppressed, demonstrating institutional flexibility in aligning education supply with sovereign security and reconstruction needs.

CHRISTIAN SCIENCE MONITOR

RETAIN

UNESCO €2.5M+ Investment in Ukraine's Scientific and Cultural Sector Anchors Knowledge Workers

UNESCO announced over €2.5 million in additional support for Ukraine's scientific and cultural reconstruction at the URC 2026. The funding targets resilience-building in institutions that are primary employers of researchers, academics, cultural professionals, and creative workers — key segments most vulnerable to permanent brain drain.

3R: Institutional investment in science and culture directly addresses Retain by sustaining the ecosystem that makes Ukraine intellectually and professionally attractive. Without viable institutions, even returning diaspora will re-emigrate. UNESCO funding helps preserve the absorptive environment.

UNESCO

URC 2026 Presidential Commitments Signal Stable Reconstruction Governance for Talent Retention

At the Ukraine Recovery Conference 2026, President von der Leyen announced new EU support frameworks for Ukraine's recovery and reconstruction. High-level international political commitment reduces sovereign risk perception, a key psychological barrier for professionals considering whether to remain in or return to Ukraine.

3R: Political legitimacy and international backing are non-monetary retention factors. Visible EU commitment signals long-term stability, reducing the uncertainty that drives brain drain. Human capital strategy must leverage these diplomatic signals in domestic talent communication campaigns.

INSTAGRAM / URC 2026

GLOBAL CONTEXT

GMF Five Perspectives on Ukraine Reconstruction Ahead of URC 2026

The German Marshall Fund published five expert perspectives on Ukraine's reconstruction priorities ahead of the 2026 Recovery Conference, noting that execution of rebuilding plans will

begin earlier than expected. The analysis covers governance, economic reform, and social resilience dimensions critical to sustainable recovery.

3R: Accelerated reconstruction timelines compress the window for human capital preparation. The GMF framing of social resilience as a recovery pillar implicitly elevates workforce development, skills policy, and diaspora engagement to strategic rather than secondary status in reconstruction planning.

FACEBOOK / GMF

OECD: Skilled Workforce as Foundation for Local Economic Development and Investment Attraction

The OECD reaffirms that a skilled workforce is a primary determinant of local economies' ability to attract investment, with OECD supporting local employment and skills policies globally. This framework is directly applicable to Ukraine's regional reconstruction hubs where investment is being channeled post-URC 2026.

3R: Provides the global evidence base linking human capital investment to investment attraction — directly validating the 3R Model's economic rationale. Ukraine's regional authorities should use OECD local development frameworks to anchor skills strategies to specific investment pipelines emerging from URC 2026 agreements.

OECD
